



IT'S
SOMEBODY
YOU KNOW

IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

Genre: Thriller / Mystery

Format: TV Movie

Setting: Present-day Atlanta

Tone: Suspenseful, emotional, sharp

Lead: Female Protagonist – Complex, Relatable, Relentless

Comparable Titles: *Gone Girl* x *Big Little Lies* x *A Stranger in My House*

LOGLINE

When a beloved Atlanta school counselor is found murdered in her home, a determined single mother and former cop must protect her daughter—and her own secrets—when all signs point to the killer being someone within their tight-knit community.

Because the most dangerous person in your life... might be somebody you know.

CONCEPT OVERVIEW

It's Somebody You Know is a pulse-pounding mystery-thriller that unfolds in one of Atlanta's historic neighborhoods, where front porches hide dark truths and smiling neighbors aren't always what they seem.

At the center is **Renee Bishop**, a widowed ex-detective turned real estate agent, whose instincts are reawakened when her daughter's best friend's mother is murdered. The investigation quickly becomes personal when Renee starts seeing disturbing parallels between this case and the unsolved death of her husband.

The closer Renee gets to the truth, the more danger she—and her daughter—are in. Secrets start unraveling. Trust starts breaking. And Renee begins to suspect that the killer isn't a stranger at all... but someone woven deeply into their everyday lives.

This is a story of female resilience, maternal instinct, and the terrifying realization that safety is sometimes a beautifully constructed illusion.

WHY THIS MOVIE?

- **Fresh Female Lead:** A smart, layered, emotionally grounded Black woman who carries the film with grit and grace.
 - **Atlanta-Centric:** Uses the rich textures of modern-day Atlanta—not just as a backdrop, but as a character. Think tree-lined streets, gentrifying neighborhoods, community politics, Southern charm with sharp edges.
 - **Relevant Themes:** Trust, domestic violence, grief, motherhood, and the double lives we all lead on social media and behind closed doors.
 - **Universal Hook:** We all think we know the people in our lives. This movie challenges that belief—and weaponizes it.
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KEY CHARACTERS

Renee Bishop (40s): A former homicide detective now selling homes and raising a teenage daughter. Tough but compassionate, she's a protector by nature—but can't protect everyone from the truth.

Maya Bishop (16): Renee's daughter, bright and opinionated, whose friendships and digital life hold more danger than she realizes.

Jordan Cook (40s): The victim. A well-liked counselor whose own secrets may have led to her murder.

Detective Marcus Shaw (50s): Renee's former partner. Protective but increasingly suspicious—of Renee.

Cassandra "Cass" Hill (40s): PTA mom, community organizer, and maybe more manipulative than anyone knows.

STRUCTURE & STYLE

- **Act I:** A murder rocks the neighborhood. Renee comforts her daughter, then gets pulled back into the investigation unofficially.
- **Act II:** Clues mount. Paranoia grows. Renee juggles a tense relationship with local police, buried trauma from her husband's death, and secrets in Maya's friend group.
- **Act III:** The twist drops: The killer isn't a stranger. The threat is painfully close. Renee must outsmart someone who knows her better than anyone.

- **Finale:** A life-or-death confrontation at a community event exposes everything—and leaves Renee changed forever.

Visual style is crisp and modern with grounded lighting, Southern gothic undertones, and emotional close-ups. Think *Sharp Objects* meets *Only Murders in the Building* but with a gritty, maternal urgency.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Women 25–54
 - Fans of Lifetime thrillers, *Big Little Lies*, *You*, and *The Undoing*
 - Viewers who love a good “twist you didn’t see coming” ending
 - Atlanta-based productions with regional pride and national appeal
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CREATIVE TEAM VISION

This is a **female-driven thriller** that’s both character-rich and high-stakes. The story centers Black women’s experiences without leaning on trauma tropes, instead showcasing strength, intuition, and vulnerability in equal measure.

The movie thrives in tension and misdirection—every character has something to hide, and every scene pushes the question: *Do you ever really know anyone?*

RENEE BISHOP (40s)

Former detective. Strong, intuitive, emotionally layered. A mother and protector at her core.

Casting Suggestions:

- **Regina Hall** – Brings both warmth and edge, perfect for a layered lead.
- **Nicole Beharie** – Grounded, soulful, with a quiet strength that explodes when needed.

- **Sanaa Lathan** – Elegant and emotionally fierce, with strong thriller presence (*The Perfect Guy*).
 - **Gabrielle Union** – Can balance vulnerability and strength, known for maternal roles and thrillers.
 - **Nia Long** – Brings grace, emotional depth, and long-standing audience trust.
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MAYA BISHOP (16)

Renee's daughter. Smart, opinionated, and quietly rebellious. Unknowingly close to danger.

Casting Suggestions:

- **Lidya Jewett** (*Nightbooks, Hidden Figures*) – Can balance innocence with growing independence.
 - **Saniyya Sidney** (*King Richard*) – Exceptional emotional range, naturalistic and expressive.
 - **Demi Singleton** (*King Richard, Godfather of Harlem*) – Brings maturity beyond her years.
 - **Navia Robinson** (*Raven's Home, Genius: MLK/X*) – Confident, Atlanta-native energy.
 - **Marsai Martin** (*Black-ish*) – Smart, sassy, and grounded when needed.
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DETECTIVE MARCUS SHAW (50s)

Renee's former partner. Loyal but increasingly suspicious. Protective of her... or hiding something?

Casting Suggestions:

- **Wendell Pierce** – Brings gravitas and emotional tension to every scene (*The Wire*).
- **Courtney B. Vance** – A master at subtle conflict and internalized pressure.
- **Mykelti Williamson** – Intense, layered, and commands presence.

- **Glynn Turman** – Adds weight, wisdom, and Southern flair.
- **Isaiah Washington** – Can play both protector and potential threat.

CASSANDRA “CASS” HILL (40s)

PTA mom, charming and helpful... but calculating. Thinks she's the smartest woman in the room.

Casting Suggestions:

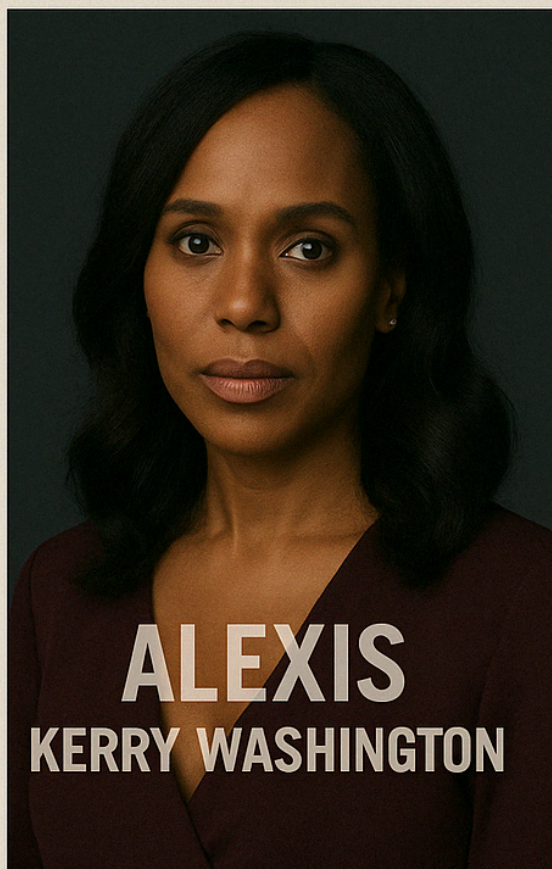
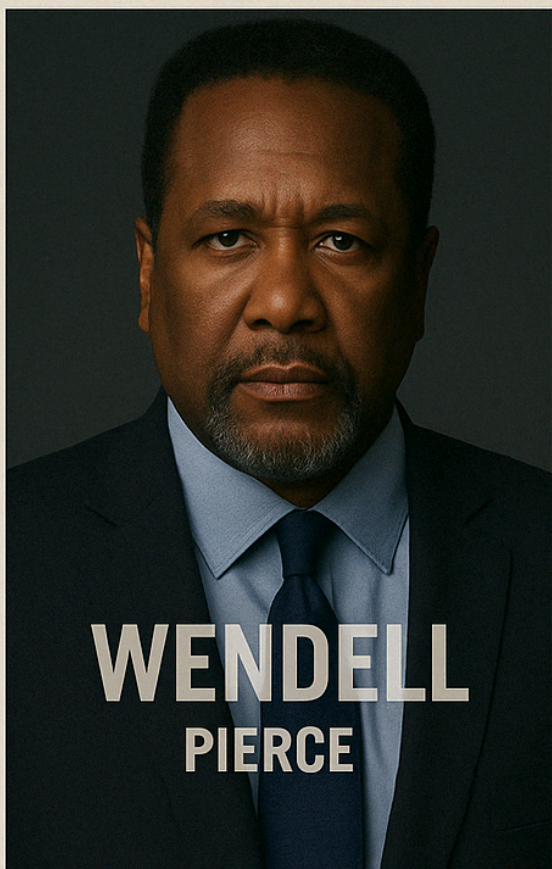
- **Kerry Washington** – Sophisticated and cunning, perfect for misdirection.
- **Aunjanue Ellis-Taylor** – Brilliant at masking emotional volatility under composure.
- **Tasha Smith** – Bold, expressive, and capable of scene-stealing manipulation.
- **Jurnee Smollett** – Can tap into polished surface with simmering fire beneath.
- **Tika Sumpter** – Stylish, confident, and excellent at complex female friendships turned rivalry.

JORDAN COOK (40s)

The victim. A beloved counselor whose double life unravels posthumously. Her secrets echo through the story.

Casting Suggestions:

- **Taraji P. Henson** – Even in flashbacks, would carry weight and emotional resonance.
 - **Yaya DaCosta** – Has a serene surface but can hint at layers underneath.
 - **Essence Atkins** – Warm and likable with a quiet emotional depth.
 - **Garcelle Beauvais** – Glamorous but mysterious, great for someone whose death shakes the community.
 - **Melinda Williams** – Evokes sympathy and curiosity.
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IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

Thriller | 1hr 30min | Set in Atlanta

When a beloved school counselor is brutally murdered in her upscale Atlanta neighborhood, shockwaves ripple through the close-knit community. But for **Renee Bishop**, a former detective turned real estate agent, the tragedy strikes too close to home. The victim was her daughter's best friend's mother—and the police are getting it all wrong.

Haunted by the unsolved murder of her own husband years earlier, Renee quietly begins her own investigation. What she uncovers is a web of secrets, lies, and betrayals—one that stretches across PTA meetings, church brunches, and neighborhood watch groups. The deeper she digs, the more she realizes: the killer isn't a stranger. It's someone they all know.

With her daughter's safety on the line, Renee must confront her past, navigate rising paranoia, and outsmart a murderer hiding in plain sight—before the truth costs her everything.

IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

Thriller | 1h 30min | Set in Atlanta

ACT I — THE CRIME & THE CALLING (0:00 – 0:30)

Opening Scene:

A peaceful Atlanta morning is shattered when **Jordan Cook**, a well-loved school counselor and community fixture, is found murdered in her home. Her daughter Olivia discovers the body.

Introduction to Renee Bishop:

Renee (early 40s), a widowed ex-cop turned real estate agent, lives in the same neighborhood. She comforts her daughter **Maya**, who was best friends with Olivia, and tries to shield her from the trauma. But the case stirs up something in Renee—grief, guilt, and suspicion.

The Past Lingers:

We learn Renee's husband, also a cop, was killed under murky circumstances. The case went unsolved. She left the force shortly after. Detective **Marcus Shaw** (her former partner) is now leading the Jordan Cook case and warns her not to get involved.

Community Reaction:

The neighborhood is shaken. There's a vigil, concerned parents, and whispers of break-ins. Renee notices people are already pointing fingers—at Olivia's father, at teenagers, at strangers.

Inciting Incident:

Renee finds something at the crime scene that doesn't sit right—Jordan's journal tucked under a loose floorboard during a house showing. What's inside suggests Jordan feared for her life—and that she knew her killer.

ACT II — THE INVESTIGATION (0:30 – 1:10)**Secret Investigation Begins:**

Renee begins digging. She talks to Jordan's friends, PTA moms, neighbors. Her instincts kick in—body language, gaps in stories, inconsistencies.

Red Herrings & Revelations:

- Jordan was having an affair with a married man.
- Someone was stalking her—unmarked letters, silent calls.
- Jordan was about to report a child protection issue at school.
- Renee starts to suspect **Cass Hill**, a seemingly perfect PTA mom with controlling tendencies.

Tension at Home:

Maya hides messages from Olivia. Renee discovers Maya was at Jordan's house the night before the murder—but left early. Maya says she heard Jordan arguing with someone, but couldn't tell who.

Flashbacks and Doubts:

Renee's trauma surfaces. We see flashbacks of her husband's murder and how the department mishandled it. Renee begins to draw parallels—was her husband silenced too?

Confrontations:

Renee confronts Cass—who reveals Jordan was about to go public with a secret that could ruin lives. Meanwhile, Renee notices Marcus is hiding something about Jordan's last call. She begins to distrust the system all over again.

Twist Revelation:

Renee discovers Jordan was gathering evidence against **Marcus Shaw**. He had a pattern of misconduct and intimidation, and Jordan had filed a sealed complaint. Renee realizes Marcus may have killed Jordan to protect himself—and may have been involved in her husband's death too.

ACT III — THE UNMASKING (1:10 – 1:30)

Renee's Race to Protect Her Daughter:

Maya is lured out by someone posing as Olivia. Renee realizes she's being followed. She races through the neighborhood's block party to find Maya—while Shaw corners her with a veiled threat: drop it or risk losing everything.

The Final Confrontation:

Renee plants a wire and arranges a meeting with Marcus under the guise of a truce. In a tense confrontation, he confesses to silencing Jordan—she knew too much, and she wouldn't stay quiet. He tries to blame her death on Jordan's "emotional instability."

Maya's Witness Moment:

Maya, secretly listening nearby, hears the truth. Her fear turns to clarity—she finally understands what her mother has been protecting her from. She calls 911.

Climax:

Police arrive. Marcus tries to flee but is caught. Renee breaks down, finally able to breathe. Her husband's case will be reopened. The community is shocked—but grateful.

Closing Scene:

Renee and Maya sit on the porch. The neighborhood is quiet again—but changed. Renee turns to her daughter:

"You know what scares me the most?"

"What?"

"That even now... I still wonder who else I don't really know."

They look out as a new family moves into Jordan's old house.

IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

TV Thriller | 90 minutes | Set in Atlanta

OPENING: A NEIGHBORHOOD SHAKEN

- *Cold Open:* Olivia discovers her mother, Jordan Cook, murdered in their home.
- *Intro to Renee Bishop:* Ex-cop turned real estate agent, raising her teen daughter Maya.

- *Emotional Hook:* Renee comforts Maya and attends the neighborhood vigil.
 - *Detective Shaw warns Renee to stay out of it.*
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MAIN PLOT: RENEE'S INSTINCTS AWAKEN

- Renee finds Jordan's hidden journal during a showing.
 - She begins a private investigation, drawing on her detective past.
 - Red herrings emerge:
 - Jordan was having an affair
 - She feared someone was stalking her
 - She was preparing to expose a school cover-up
 - Renee interviews neighbors and fellow parents.
 - Maya becomes increasingly secretive.
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CHARACTER MOVES: SECRETS AND SUSPICIONS

- *Renee vs. Marcus Shaw:* Their old partnership turns adversarial.
 - *Cass Hill* emerges as a potential suspect—too perfect, too controlling.
 - Renee uncovers that Jordan had filed a sealed complaint—against Shaw.
 - Maya admits she was at Jordan's house the night before her death—but won't say what she heard.
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CLIFFHANGER: THE KILLER IS CLOSE

- Renee learns Shaw may have covered up her husband's murder years ago.
- She realizes Shaw has been watching her and might move against her or Maya.

- Maya is lured out via a fake message—Renee races to find her.
-

ACT III: TRUTH AND CONSEQUENCES

- *Final Setup:* Renee sets a trap—recording a conversation with Shaw.
 - *Climax:* Shaw confesses to Jordan's murder and implicates himself in past cover-ups.
 - *Police arrive in time; Maya had called them.*
 - *Shaw is arrested. Renee and Maya finally feel safe—but changed.*
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ENDING IMAGE:

- Renee and Maya sit on the porch as a new family moves in next door.
 - Renee's voiceover: "You never really know someone... until you do."
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TITLE: IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

WRITTEN BY: KELLY R. TENNEY

GENRE: THRILLER

RUN TIME: 90 MINUTES

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Title: It's Somebody You Know

Genre: Thriller / Mystery

Format: TV Movie

Setting: Present-day Atlanta, Georgia

Tone: Suspenseful, emotional, grounded

Lead: Strong, emotionally complex Black female protagonist

Platform Fit: Lifetime Original Movie

LOGLINE

When a beloved Atlanta school counselor is found murdered in her home, a widowed ex-cop turned real estate agent reawakens her instincts to protect her daughter and uncover the truth—only to discover the killer may be someone in their own circle. Because the most dangerous threats don't come from strangers—they come from somebody you know.

WHY THIS STORY WORKS

- **Female-led with agency:** Renee Bishop is sharp, vulnerable, and determined—a complex Black woman at the center of a gripping mystery.
 - **Atlanta as a character:** Urban and historic, filled with secrets behind its Southern charm.
 - **High-concept thriller meets emotional depth:** Combines mystery, maternal stakes, and social relevance.
 - **Universal fear:** The story taps into the primal fear of betrayal by someone close.
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STRUCTURE AT A GLANCE

ACT I: A shocking murder rattles a quiet Atlanta neighborhood. Renee, a former homicide detective, begins to see signs that something isn't right—and may be tied to her late husband's mysterious death.

ACT II: As Renee digs deeper, she discovers Jordan (the victim) was hiding something dangerous. The list of suspects narrows, and Renee realizes the killer may be someone she's known for years. Her daughter becomes a target.

ACT III: Renee sets a trap. The final reveal exposes two co-conspirators: a corrupt detective and a manipulative PTA mom. Renee outsmarts them both, but the last text message suggests the danger isn't over.

CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

RENEE BISHOP (40s): Ex-cop. Now a real estate agent and mother. Tough, intuitive, haunted

by her past.

MAYA BISHOP (16): Renee's daughter. Smart, social, guarded. Unwittingly caught in the crosshairs.

MARCUS SHAW (50s): Renee's former partner on the force. Charming and trusted—but hiding a deadly secret.

CASS HILL (40s): PTA mom and local queen bee. Cold, calculating, obsessed with control.

JORDAN COOK (40s): The murder victim. A school counselor with buried secrets and a link to Renee's past.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Women 25–54
 - Fans of *Big Little Lies*, *The Undoing*, and *You*
 - Viewers drawn to female-led thrillers and neighborhood-set mysteries
 - Lifetime, Netflix, BET+, OWN, and Hallmark Mahogany buyers
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VISUAL STYLE

- Sleek, grounded realism with saturated natural lighting
 - Atlanta's unique neighborhoods: brick bungalows, church halls, suburban streets, and modern developments
 - Tense, intimate camerawork to evoke paranoia and personal danger
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COMPARABLES

- *Big Little Lies* (secrets among seemingly perfect lives)
 - *Gone Girl* (female-driven suspense with emotional intelligence)
 - *Only Murders in the Building* (community-based mystery)
 - *The Stranger* (the threat from someone close)
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CREATIVE TEAM INTENTION

This thriller centers Black women in emotional, psychological, and high-stakes narratives without trauma voyeurism. It offers suspense with humanity, twists grounded in real emotion, and a powerful lead role built to attract A-list talent.

STATUS: Ready for development. Outline, beat sheet, and sample scenes complete.
Ask: Seeking producing partners, network acquisition, or development funding.

CONTACT: NCCA ENTERTAINMENT INC. 910.262.3456
Created by: KELLY R. TENNEY

Lifetime

ORIGINAL MOVIE

IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

THRILLER • ATLANTA



RENEE
SONEQUA MARTIN-GREEN



MARCUS
MICHAEL EALY



CASS
ALLISON JANNEY



SHAW
MALCOLM-JAMAL WARNER

PITCH DECK

TEASER TRAILER SCRIPT

TITLE: IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

FORMAT: Lifetime Original Movie Promo (0:50)

[FADE IN: Slow drone shot over a quiet Atlanta neighborhood at sunrise]

VO (female, intense, calm):

"We trust our neighbors... wave from the porch... share secrets over coffee..."

[Cut to: A SCHOOL COUNSELOR'S DOOR — WIDE OPEN. Police tape flutters.]

VO:

"But what if the person you trust... is the one you should fear?"

[Series of QUICK FLASHES]

- Renee opening a journal, eyes wide.
 - Maya walking alone at night.
 - Cass turning slowly at a PTA meeting.
 - A blurry man watching from a parked SUV.
 - Renee gripping a gun with trembling hands.
-

VO (building):

"When a murder shakes a quiet Atlanta neighborhood—one woman must uncover the truth..."

[INTENSE MUSIC RISES]

RENEE (to Shaw):

"You didn't stop him then. I will now."

SHAW (cold):

"Dig too deep, you won't like what you find."

[Final montage – rapid cuts]

- A candlelight vigil
 - Maya running through the woods
 - A bloody photograph
 - Renee standing in the dark, whispering:
 "It was never a stranger."
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[BLACK SCREEN. Then, bold red text:]

IT'S SOMEBODY YOU KNOW

A Lifetime Original Movie

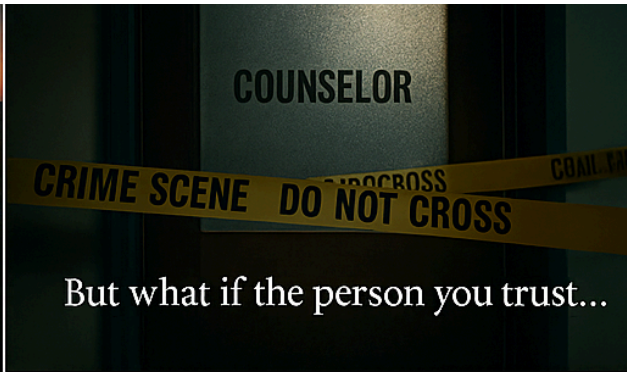
[VO — final whisper]

"Trust is a killer."

[END FRAME: Lifetime Logo + Premiere Date Placeholder]



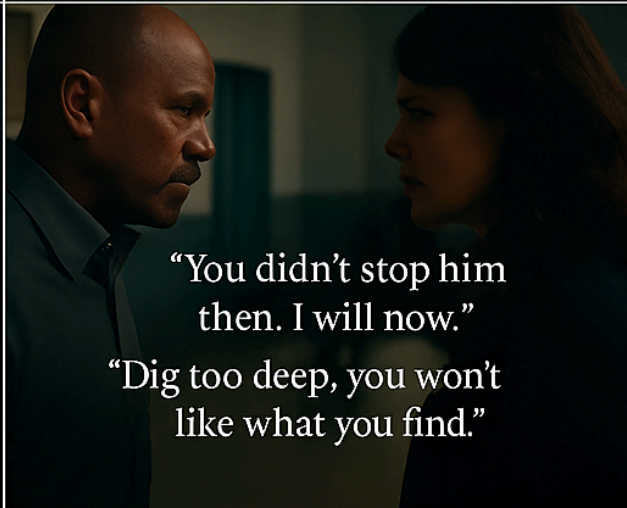
We trust our neighbors...



But what if the person you trust...



When a murder shakes a quiet
Atlanta neighborhood—
one woman must uncover
the truth...



“You didn’t stop him
then. I will now.”
“Dig too deep, you won’t
like what you find.”



**IT'S SOMEBODY
YOU KNOW**

A LIFETIME ORIGINAL MOVIE

Trust is a killer